



called Dawaki, 200 km from Shillong, dish antennas stand out conspicuously, even as other trappings of even a small town are missing. But with the arrival of satellite TV, the situation has changed and households are buying consumer electronic items. Be it Thanjavur in Tamil Nadu or a remote village near Amravati in Maharashtra, rural India is shining. Bharat—of six lakh villages—is finally finding its place under the marketing sun, as urban India reels under the impact of a global slowdown. R. Seshadri, CEO of rural marketing firm Anugrah Madison, says: “Until 15 years ago, rural markets were synonymous with

farmers. The television revolution, liberalisation of the economy and increasing competition has forced marketers to move deeper into the countryside. What’s truly reinforced this reality is a steady demand for products and services from rural India, despite the current global economic slowdown.”

Four good monsoons, a loan waiver bonanza and rising support prices have increased liquidity in the hands of rural consumers and marketers can no longer afford to ignore them. Says Abheek Singhi, partner and director, The Boston Consulting Group: “Even though the top six metros account for only 17 per

Samsung India (Consumer Electronics)

RURAL INITIATIVE: In a rural road show called Dream Home series, Samsung hosts four-day exhibitions in small towns. The company hires a place to showcase its products and engages vans to popularise the events. It offers various deals on its products and builds brand awareness through these events.

RURAL SALES: **Rs 1,400 crore***

ALL INDIA SALES: **Rs 7,500 crore***

**Estimates*

cent of purchasing power, over 50-60 per cent of the media spend happens in these markets. Companies are now realising that urban markets are fast saturating and growth will only come from rural markets.”

The numbers speak for themselves. On the back of increased

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